

Mir Rafiul Ahmed

Corvallis, OR 97330 | Phone: (+1) (207) 735-9232 | rafiulahmed40@gmail.com

LinkedIn | Website | GitHub | Google Scholar | ORCID

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Energy Economics, Environmental & Resource Economics, and Public Policy

Subfields: Renewable Energy Transitions, Energy Infrastructure Policy & Siting, Energy Access & Development, Policy Evaluation, Applied Microeconomics

EDUCATION

University of Maine

Sep 2024 – May 2026

M.S. in Economics (Concentration: Applied Economics)

CGPA: 3.79/4.0 (Completed with Outstanding International Graduate Student Award 2025–26)

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology, Sylhet

Feb 2018 – Feb 2023

B.S.S. in Economics

CGPA: 3.79/4.0 (Completed with academic distinction, *Magna cum Laude*)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Noblet PFAS Lab

Jul 2026 – Present

Research Assistant

Supervisor: Dr. Caroline L. Noblet, Professor, UMaine School of Economics

Project Involvement:

U.S. Seafood Consumption: Examines a NOAA funded research project about U.S. consumers' perceptions, preferences, and barriers to seafood consumption, comparing Northeast and major-city consumer samples across socioeconomic groups and regional markets

Food Security & PFAS in Fresh and Processed Foods: Examines how information about PFAS contamination relates to consumer confidence in fresh versus processed foods, and whether these responses differ across geographic scales.

Key Responsibilities:

- Serving as lead author on the NOAA seafood manuscript, including hypothesis development, analysis, and drafting for peer-review submission.
- Contributing as a second author to the PFAS food security manuscript through data analysis and manuscript writing.
- Conducting statistical analysis in Stata, including hypothesis testing and interpretation of survey results.
- Presenting analysis results and manuscript progress at regular research team meetings.

UMaine School of Economics

Dec 2024 – May 2026

Graduate Research Assistant

Experimental Environmental Economics & PFAS Contamination: Conducted experimental research on how people interpret and respond to PFAS contamination, focusing on public awareness, risk perception, and behavioral impacts on rural resilience and Maine's food systems.

Marine Aquaculture Market Analysis: Contributed to research aimed at expanding market opportunities for Maine's marine aquaculture industry by prioritizing supply chain analysis, identifying seafood market barriers, and analyzing consumer preferences to inform policy and industry strategy.

Key Responsibilities:

- Assisted in designing, conducting, and analyzing controlled experiments and studies.
- Collaborated with faculty and research teams on manuscript preparation for peer-reviewed journals.
- Supported grant-funded research, including literature reviews, technical report writing, and compliance.
- Prepared and delivered research presentations for academic conferences and stakeholder workshops.

Municipal Project Analyst

Jan 2025 – May 2025

Service-Learning Project, Bethel Energy Conservation Committee
Town of Bethel, ME

Completed a semester-long service-learning engagement with the Town of Bethel, Maine, contributing a cost-benefit analysis to inform a five-year municipal sustainable energy and efficiency plan.

Key Contributions:

- Consolidated electricity and heating data for six municipal facilities into energy baselines and load profiles.
- Co-led a solar PV feasibility assessment paired with a cost-benefit analysis framework accessible to non-technical stakeholders.
- Developed a dual-track plan integrating phased solar adoption and targeted efficiency measures, with explicit sequencing guidance.
- Produced public-facing materials and presented findings at Town Hall, incorporating stakeholder feedback into final deliverables.

South Asian Network on Economic Modeling (SANEM)

Feb 2023 – May 2024

Senior Research Assistant
Dhaka, Bangladesh

Key Responsibilities:

- Contributed to an assessment of Bangladesh's renewable energy landscape, reviewing policy targets, deployment trends, and barriers to scaling up renewable generation.
- Co-authored an analysis of the power and energy sector allocations in Bangladesh's FY2023-24 national budget, examining spending priorities for generation, fuel imports, and renewable energy.
- Analyzed and interpreted energy and economic data and drafted research reports and policy briefs for government and donor audiences.
- Designed questionnaires, conducted FGDs, KIIs, and IDIs, and managed field enumerator teams for national household and firm surveys.
- Authored project proposals for international foundations, donor agencies, and government partners.

Project involvement with the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**, **World Bank**, **Asian Development Bank (ADB)**, and **International Labour Organization (ILO)**.

SUST Research Center

Jul 2022 – Dec 2022

Undergraduate Research Assistant (Contractual)
Sylhet, Bangladesh

Worked on a funded project that examined the impact of poverty on cognitive development in farmers in Sunamganj, Sylhet, under the supervision of Md. Gias Uddin Khan and Dr. M.A.H. Pradhan.

Key Responsibilities included survey design (including KII, FGD, IDI), fieldwork coordination, data analysis, literature review, and drafting research chapters.

South Asian Network on Economic Modeling (SANEM)

Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

Research Intern

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Assisted in data analysis, literature reviews, and the preparation of research reports and policy briefs on development and labor market issues in South Asia.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

School of Economics, University of Maine

Sep 2024 – Dec 2024

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Fall 2024

Courses: ECO 220 Intermediate Microeconomics; ECO 403/503 Experimental Economics

- Assisted the lead instructor with lesson planning, course materials, and grading.
- Led review sessions and facilitated classroom discussions.
- Held tutoring and office hours for students working through difficult material.

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Godin, M. J., Noblet, C. L., Furtado, C. H., **Ahmed, M. R.**, & Kopec, A. D. (2026). Tradition in transition: Fishing, hunting, and food security in a changing Maine. *Maine Policy Review*, 34(2). [Article]

Work Under Review

Ahmed, M. R., Uyar, M., Evans, K. S., & Noblet, C. L. (2025). Perceptions, preferences, and barriers: Insights into U.S. seafood consumption behavior. *Aquaculture Economics & Management*.

Technical Reports

Noblet, C. L., Kopec, D., Godin, M., **Ahmed, R.**, Amegbor, G., Shea, M., Furtado, C., Penlington, P., & LaForge, B. (2025, September). *Assessing Maine anglers' preferences for fish consumption*. Maine Department of Inland Fisheries and Wildlife, Fisheries & Hatcheries Bureau.

Raihan, S., Bidisha, S. H., Ahmed, M. T., Hossain, I., Chowdhury, O. R., Asaduzzaman, M., Surid, T. F., & **Ahmed, M. R.** (2024). *An analysis of the power and energy sector in the FY2023–24 national budget*. SANEM Publications, Dhaka, Bangladesh.

Conference Presentations

Ahmed, M. R., Uyar, M., Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2026). From tourist to trusted consumer: Maine visitation's impact on seafood consumption, barrier & quality ratings. *Aquaculture America 2026*, Las Vegas, NV, United States. [Poster]

Uyar, M., **Ahmed, M. R.**, Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2025). Tapping into unmet demand for U.S. seafood: Can Maine lead the way? *Maine Blue Economy Innovation Summit 2025*, Portland, ME, United States. [Poster]

Ahmed, M. R., Noblet, C. L., & Evans, K. S. (2025). Reeling in the facts: How do U.S. consumers view seafood quality and the marine environment? *UMaine Student Symposium*, Orono, ME, United States. [Poster]

Khan, G. U., **Ahmed, M. R.**, & Shaïd, A. (2023). Does poverty hinder cognitive development? An empirical study from Sylhet. *SANEM 6th Annual Economists' Conference*, Dhaka, Bangladesh. [Conference Paper]

Op-ed/Analytical Feature

- Aahad, A., & **Ahmed, R.** (2024, March 15). Miles to go to develop a healthier Bangladesh. *The Business Standard*. [Article]
- Das, D., & **Ahmed, R.** (2023). Women's career aspirations, role in the workforce, and pay gap: Nobel Prize in Economics 2023. *Thinking Aloud*, 10(7). [Article]
- Raihan, S., Sharmin, E., Das, P., & **Ahmed, R.** (2023). Towards a women financial inclusion strategy of Bangladesh (WFIS-B). *Thinking Aloud*, 10(5). [Article]

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Software	Stata, R, MATLAB
GIS & Visualization	ArcGIS, QGIS, Tableau, Power BI
Econometrics	Regression analysis, hypothesis testing, time series analysis and forecasting, applied statistics
Spatial Analysis	GIS mapping, remote sensing data processing
Data Workflow	Data cleaning, wrangling, visualization, modeling, and interpretation
Survey Platforms	Qualtrics, SurveyCTO, KoboToolbox, Google Forms
Typesetting & Office	L ^A T _E X, MS Office, Google Workspace

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCES

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| • President, UMaine School of Economics Graduate Student Club | Jul 2025 – Jun 2026 |
| • Vice-President, UMaine Bangladesh Student Association | Sep 2024 – Aug 2025 |
| • Founder and Executive Director, Econ Insider | Apr 2020 – Apr 2022 |
| • Branding and Communication Secretary, SUST Economic Association | Jul 2019 – Jul 2020 |
| • Executive Member, Bangladesh Economics Students Network | Oct 2019 – Oct 2020 |

CERTIFICATIONS

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| • IRB Member, CITI Program | Jan 2025 |
| • Social and Behavioral Research, CITI Program | Jan 2025 |

AWARDS & HONORS

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| • Roger D. Coopman Outstanding International Graduate Student Scholarship, Office of International Programs, University of Maine | 2024 & 2025 |
| • Charles H. and Katherine C. Merchant Scholarship, University of Maine | 2025–26 |
| • Semifinalist, International Blockchain Olympiad, Bangladesh | 2022 |
| • Participated in 18 business and policy case competitions and secured multiple achievements. | |